Purpose

1. To relieve dysponea.
2. To administer low concentration of oxygen to patients.
3. To allow uninterrupted supply of oxygen during activities like eating, drinking, etc.

Procedure

Sl.No	NURSING ACTION	RATIONALE
1	Determine need for oxygen therapy in patient. Check physician's order for rate, device used concentration, etc	Reduce risk of error in administration.
2	Perform an assessment of vital signs, level of consciousness, lab values, etc. and record.	Provides a baseline for future assessment.
3	Assess risk factors of oxygen therapy, patient and environment such as patients with the dangers of smoking when oxygen is on flow.	Reduces risk of danger to the patient.
4	Explain procedure to patient and relatives and inform them how to cooperate.	Reduces anxiety and ensures cooperation
5	Post "No Smoking" sign on the patient's door in view of patient and visitors	Oxygen supports combustion, smoking in oxygen area can lead to fire hazards.
6	Wash hands	Reduces risk of transmission of microorganisms.
7	Set up oxygen equipments and humidifier a. Fill humidifier up to the level marked on it with sterile water b. Attach flow meter to source, set flow meter in 'off' position. c. Attach humidifier to base of flow meter d. Attach tubing and nasal cannula to humidifier e. Regulate flow meter to prescribed level f. Ensure proper functioning by checking for bubbles in humidifier or feeling oxygen at the outlet.	Filling beyond this point will cause water to enter tubing. Flow meter helps in monitoring and regulating oxygen flow to patient Humidification helps in preventing drying of mucous membranes and promotes comfort of patient. Oxygen is a drug and is dangerous to administer at flow rates greater or lesser than prescribed level. Kinks in the tubing will obstruct flow of oxygen through tube.
8	Place tips of cannula to patient's nares and adjust straps around ear for snug fit. The elastic band may be fixed behind head or under chin	Proper fixing ensures comfort and prevents chances of cannula slipping from nostrils.

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